

Tenant Retention and Occupancy Improvement

A Business Analysis Case Study

Role	Business Analyst -advisory + hands-on implementation
Engagement type	Independent advisory project
Duration	August 2024 - February 2025 (~6 months)
Scale	Single property · ~360 beds
Tools / methods	Exit interviews (VoC), Root Cause Analysis (5 Whys), Gap analysis, SWOT, Competitive benchmarking, Vendor analysis, Phased rollout

1. Background & Business Problem

A paying-guest (co-living) property opened in June 2024. Occupancy rose quickly to 280 tenants by January 2025, then steadily declined to 196 by July 2025 -a ~30% drop in six months, driven by a wave of departures with almost no new admissions to offset them.

The owner could clearly see falling occupancy and revenue but had no diagnosis of the root cause and no structured plan to stop the bleeding. I was engaged in mid-August 2025 to identify why tenants were leaving and to recommend -and help implement -corrective action.

Occupancy timeline

Date	Occupancy	Status
June 2024	-	Property opens
Jan 2025	280	Early peak
Jul 2025	196	Trough -down ~30% (-84)
mid-Aug 2025	-	Engagement begins; tenant interviews
Aug 2025 – Feb 2026	Steadily Rising	6-month implementation period
Feb 2026	304	Recovered to above pre-decline peak

2. Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Role / interest
Property owner	Sponsor -occupancy, revenue, retention
Current & exiting tenants	End users / customers -service quality, value, safety
Cleaning staff / cleaning vendor	Service delivery (high in-house turnover = a root cause)
Local gym partner	Amenity partner (phased solution)

3. Approach & Analysis

3.1 Elicitation -Exit Interviews (Voice of Customer)

Rather than assume why people were leaving, I went to the source and interviewed all ~25 tenants who had submitted notice in the month of July 24.

- approx 8- 9 were leaving for un-addressable reasons (genuine relocation to another area).
- ~16 cited addressable service or value issues.

I presented the second group a concrete 2-month improvement plan and asked them to wait before leaving, 7 agreed to stay immediately.

3.2 Thematic Analysis

Grouping the interview findings produced two clear themes:

A. Internal service failures

1. Decline in cleaning quality.
2. Shared cooking utensils routinely left dirty (owned by the PG, rarely washed)- a recurring source of inter-tenant conflict.
3. Common area under-delivered vs. what was promised -too few games, an open floor with too few tables/chairs.

B. Competitive gaps

1. Competitors bundled food at the same price.
2. Competitors offered indoor/table games.
3. Competitors offered biometric-secured floors, increasing tenants' sense of safety.

3.3 Root Cause Analysis (5 Whys)

The cleaning complaint was a symptom, not the cause:

Cleaning is poor → because quality is inconsistent → because cleaning staff keep quitting → because they leave within weeks without notice → because the in-house staffing model is unsustainable and hard to manage.

This pointed to a structural fix (change the staffing model) rather than a cosmetic one (push the existing staff harder).

4. Gap Analysis

Area	expected state	Actual state	Recommended action
Cleaning	Consistent daily cleaning	Inconsistent due to staff churn	Outsource to a 3rd-party vendor
Common area	Functional recreation space	Few games, too few tables/chairs	Add tables; host match-viewing events
Safety	Secure for residents	Open guest access, no floor control	Guards + access policy; biometric doors (pending)
Amenities	Competitive with area	No food/gym/games parity	Gym partnership → in-house gym; add games
Parking	Orderly parking	Vehicles frequently blocked	Re-mark layout to minimize blocking

5. SWOT Analysis

Strengths -Established location; existing tenant base; common-area infrastructure already in place.

Weaknesses -Unstable cleaning quality; no food option; thin amenities; safety-perception gap; parking friction.

Opportunities -Differentiate on service quality and amenities; low-cost partnerships (gym); recover churn through targeted fixes.

Threats -Nearby PGs matching the rent along with food options, table games, and biometric safety.

6. Recommendations & Implementation

I both advised on and helped implement the solutions, including running the vendor analysis and selection for the cleaning changeover.

#	Action	BA classification	Status (Feb 2026)
1	Replace in-house cleaning with a 3rd-party vendor	Make-vs-buy / vendor management	Implemented
2	Remove PG-owned utensils; tenants bring their own	Process re-design / conflict removal	Implemented
3	Add tables; host cricket football match events	Amenity enhancement	Implemented
4	Gym: free 3-month tie-up -> in-house gym	Phased pilot-then-scale rollout	Implemented (in-house gym built)

5	Security guards + access policy (guests -> common floor only; leave by 8 PM)	Risk mitigation / policy control	Implemented
6	Biometric floor doors	Safety enhancement	Pending / under consideration
7	Re-mark parking to reduce blocked vehicles	Process optimization	Implemented

7. Outcome

- Occupancy reversed from its trough of 196 (Jul 2025) to 304 (Feb 2026) -a +55% recovery from the low, finishing above the pre-decline peak of 280, over roughly 6 months of intervention.
- Retained 6 of the ~16 addressable would-be leavers in the first interview cohort through a structured 2-month improvement plan.
- The decline (280 - 196) occurred before the engagement and reversed after the interventions rolled out -a strong timing signal for impact.

Attribution note : Multiple changes were implemented together, and external factors may have contributed, so the result is not claimed as the effect of any single lever. The core contribution was diagnosing the full system of causes from primary research -the input the owner previously lacked -and converting it into a prioritized, owner-adopted action plan.

8. BA Skills Demonstrated

Stakeholder analysis · Voice of Customer / exit interviews · Root cause analysis (5 Whys) · Thematic analysis · Gap analysis · SWOT · Competitive benchmarking · Vendor analysis & selection · Solution recommendation · Phased implementation · Process re-design · Change management